

Creating VPN with OpenVPN

In this article we'll take a look at two of the most commonly used configurations for OpenVPN.



Virtual Private Networks, or VPN for short, allow us to establish a private network over a public network (like the Internet) using cryptography to secure it. An SSL VPN uses an SSL (Secure Sockets Layer), enabling the service to be accessible over the HTTPS protocol using a Web browser. OpenVPN is an example of an SSL VPN solution that's open source and is targeted at SMEs and enterprises.

A wide range of configurations exist for OpenVPN, including site-to-site VPNs,

remote access, Wi-Fi security, etc. It uses the TUN interface for virtual linking of the two end points of the VPN. The TUN interface looks like a point-to-point network hardware device to the operating system, but is, in fact, nothing but a virtual network adapter. Thus being a virtual interface, the data is actually pushed to the user-space program, which can then open a TUN device (like a file), and read and write IP packets from and to it.

Note that a TAP interface is similar to TUN except that it emulates the Ethernet